

tion to fire at our men. We have sent a report to the officials concerned," says a Home Ministry official.

Indian officials say that by asking Indian soldiers to vacate their own territory, Chinese troops have violated all norms. Under the broad understanding reached by the two sides, even if there is proximity during patrolling, they are not supposed to engage each other. The Chinese intrusion was against the diplomatic mechanism that had been set up to avoid such incidents.

The two countries had agreed to maintain peace on the LAC through an agreement in 1993, followed by an agreement on confidence building

measures along the border to prevent conflict-like situations. The present face-off is a clear violation of the treaty. Sources say that the confidential report on the incident reveals that the Chinese troops had written abuses directed at Indians on trees in the region.

"How can the Government say there is no tension on the India-China boundary? Such incidents can escalate into a conflict situation. It needs to be taken seriously and tackled by holding more border level meetings and then taking it to a political level," says former army chief General V.P. Malik.

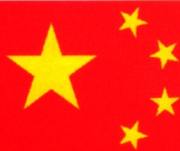
Last year, INDIA TODAY first reported the Chinese intrusions into Indian

territory in Sikkim. Close to 400 such incidents have occurred in the last three years. And things have not improved. Despite India's diplomatic protests, the Chinese intrusions have only increased. This year alone, 90 intrusions have been reported to the Government by various security and border agencies. India has been repeatedly complaining to Beijing.

In some cases, the intrusions were extremely provocative. In April this year, Chinese troops came 12 kilometres inside Maja in Arunachal Pradesh. "We don't know about this incident, but most of this area is no man's land and there is no clear demarcation, so such incidents occur. But we are trying to resolve the issue through a border talks mechanism," a Chinese diplomat told INDIA TODAY.

Sources say that the intelligence agencies reported the matter to the Foreign Office, which has maintained silence over the issue, though such cases are a violation of the agreement between the two nuclear powers.

The much-hyped friendship between the two Asian powers got a reality check as the Chinese violation of the border agreement with India led to a dangerous face-off in Ladakh



INTRUDERS:
PLA taking positions

LINE OF CONFLICT

- THE INCIDENT IS A VIOLATION OF THE 1993 INDIA-CHINA AGREEMENT ON PEACE AND TRANQUILITY ON THE LINE OF ACTUAL CONTROL.
- NINETY INCIDENTS OF INTRUSIONS BY CHINESE SOLDIERS HAVE BEEN REPORTED THIS YEAR ALONE.
- THE DISPUTE BETWEEN THE TWO COUNTRIES INVOLVES THE LONGEST CONTESTED BOUNDARY IN THE WORLD.